

Report for Joshua Berman

Term 3, 2021
Perkins House
Year 12



Perkins House

It has been a pleasure getting to know Joshua over the course of this year as his House Master. I have only previously interacted with him, whilst on CITF in Year 10. It is evident that he is a very charismatic, energetic and passionate person. He has been invaluable in Perkins House and I will be forever grateful in how he took over and ran the Inter-House Futsal for all age groups. I have been especially pleased that he picked my area of speciality of shark biology for his Science Extension project, as it gave us a different area to connect with and I was able to see his passion for the area of study. It was pleasing to see his report, especially as his teachers see the same mature and motivated student I see around the House. I do hope that Joshua heeds the guidance given by his teachers, in the lead up to his final HSC examinations. It has been a very turbulent time for Year 12, but it has been rewarding to know that Joshua has been working hard, despite being in distance learning. I wish him every success for the future, as I know he will continue to thrive and do wonderful things.

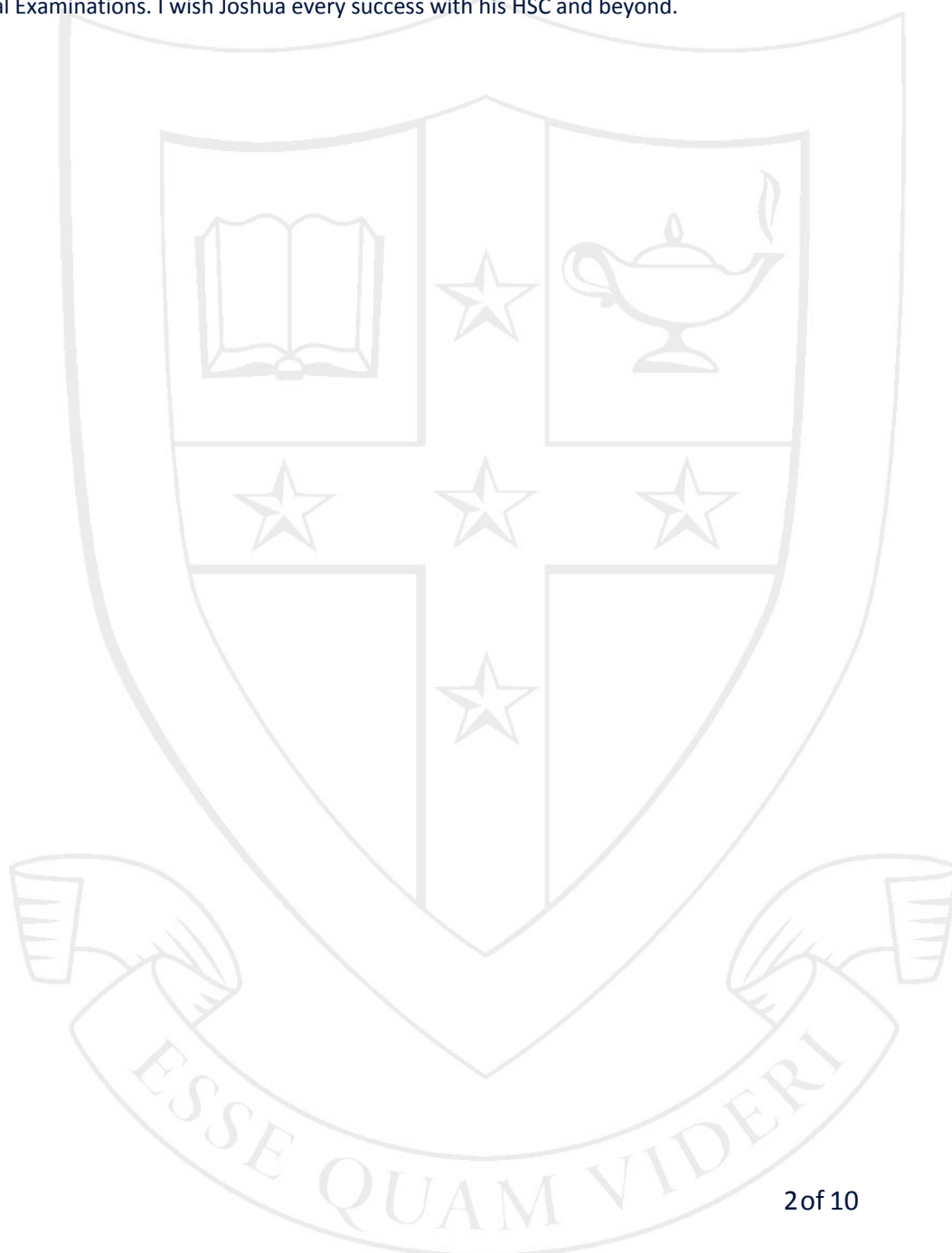
Mentor: Miss Ruby Yang

Housemaster: Mr Craig Mills

This is a fine report for a mature and engaging young man. Joshua has coped admirably with the challenges to Term 3 and recorded some strong marks in his Trial Examinations. I wish Joshua every success with his HSC and beyond.



Mr Robert Meakin
Head of Senior School



Academic summary

	Course	Performance grade	Rank in assessment tasks
Economics	2 Unit	A	Task 4: =19/56
English Advanced	2 Unit	B	Task 4: 24/94
Mathematics Advanced	2 Unit	A	Task 4: =22/68
Mathematics Extension 1	1 Unit	B	Task 4: 33/46
Physics	2 Unit	C	Task 4: 13/26
Science Extension	1 Unit	B	Task 3: 5/6

Explanatory Notes

Performance Grade: The following Performance Grade Scale indicates student performance in each secondary year at Cranbrook School.

It describes performance at each of five grade levels, based on classwork, homework and assessment tasks.

A The student has an extensive knowledge and understanding of the content and can readily apply this knowledge. In addition, the student has achieved a very high level of competence in the processes and skills and can apply these skills to new situations.

B The student has a thorough knowledge and understanding of the content and a high level of competence in the processes and skills. In addition, the student is able to apply this knowledge and these skills to most situations.

C The student has a sound knowledge and understanding of the main areas of content and has achieved an adequate level of competence in the processes and skills.

D The student has a basic knowledge and understanding of the content and has achieved a limited level of competence in the processes and skills.

E The student has an elementary knowledge and understanding in few areas of the content and has achieved very limited competence in some of the processes and skills.

Economics

2 Unit

With the shift to distance learning due to Covid-19 restrictions, students ended their Economics course from home. Students learnt about the aims and operation of macroeconomic and microeconomic policies in the Australian economy. Students researched these policies and considered their impacts. Research on the Chinese economy was also conducted.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding				✓
investigating			✓	
communicating			✓	
thinking critically			✓	

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: =19/56

Josh has remained a mature and motivated learner in Economics and as a result has developed a strong understanding of the many complex aspects of the course. His hard work has translated to impressive results. I congratulate him the way he has coped with distance learning and all the Covid-19 related disruptions. Despite an impressive result in the trial examination, I know the essays were disappointing for him and ensuring he adds necessary detail, including limitations discussion for policy questions, will be important in the HSC examination. He may now turn his attention to course revision and planning unseen questions. Submitting work to me for feedback is recommended. Josh has been a pleasure to teach and I congratulate him on the success he has rightfully enjoyed in Economics.

Teacher: Mrs Paulina White

English Advanced

2 Unit

Students completed their HSC Trials. As part of their revision for this task, students developed study techniques, consulted a range of sample responses and constructed responses to HSC style questions, including practice papers under timed conditions.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
analysing			✓	
organising			✓	
producing text			✓	
using language			✓	

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: B Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: 24/94

Joshua has been working deliberating, especially in terms of writing more clearly and to make substantial points rather than his losing his ideas in verbose expression. He has made progress in these areas as reflected in his solid performance in the HSC Trial examinations, particularly in the Reading Task and his essay on Camus and Daoud. It is important that he has a break to decompress so that when he returns to his studies, he can determine how to effectively answer set questions and express his ideas with clarity and specificity. Completing practice papers, reverse engineering model responses, and forging links to the rubric will consolidate his performance. It has been a pleasure teaching Joshua; he is a hardworking a committed student.

Teacher: Mr Thomas McDonnell

Mathematics Advanced

2 Unit

Students finished the course by looking at Sequences and Series and their Financial Applications. For the rest of the term, they completed individualised revision of areas of concern using teacher seminars and Past Papers before sitting the Trial exam in order to prepare for their HSC exam.

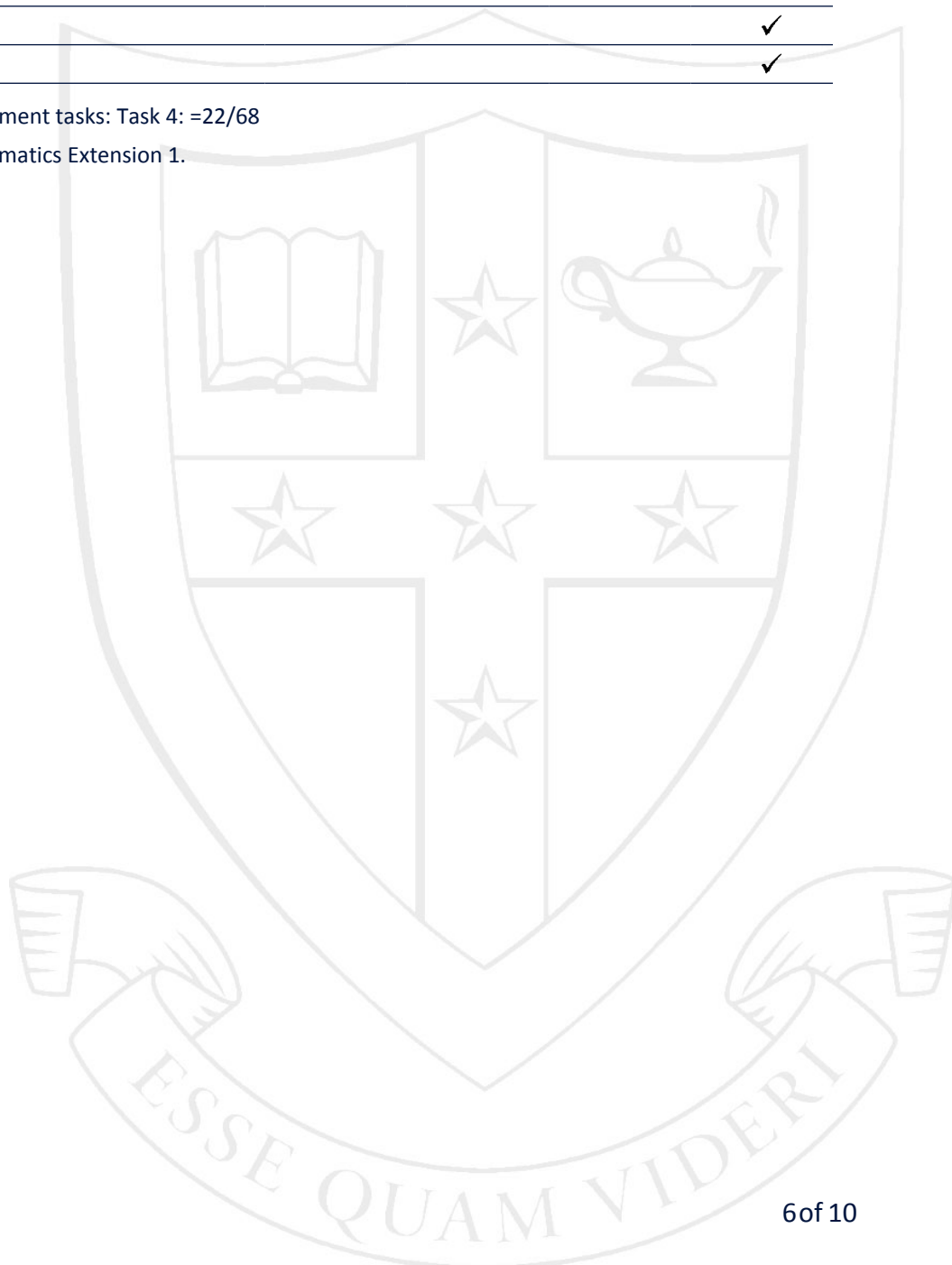
Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding			✓	
investigating patterns			✓	
communicating			✓	
applying mathematics in real-world contexts			✓	

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: =22/68

Please refer to the comment in Mathematics Extension 1.

Teacher: Mr Matthew Fanning



Mathematics Extension 1

1 Unit

Students learn about the binomial distribution and mathematical induction. They completed their trial examination and used the feedback from this examination to determine topics which need further study and application for their HSC exam.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding		✓		
investigating patterns		✓		
communicating		✓		
applying mathematics in real-world contexts		✓		

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: B Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: 33/46

Joshua is a polite and diligent student who is a pleasure to teach. He applies himself well in both the Advanced and Extension 1 courses. He has a comprehensive understanding of the core concepts and is continuing to refine his knowledge of the complex concepts. His strengths are in integration, sequence and series as well as functions and their graphs. I encourage him to revise harder geometrical applications of differentiation, probability and continuous random variables in order to be prepared for the HSC. It has been a delight to teach Joshua and I wish him all the best in his future endeavours.

Teacher: Mr Matthew Fanning

Physics

2 Unit

Students learn about the formation of matter during the big bang. This leads to a consideration of nuclear physics and the atomic theory throughout the nineteenth century. Students finish with today's quantum mechanical model of the atom and the standard model of matter.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding			✓	
inquiring and designing			✓	
processing and evaluating			✓	
reflecting on the impacts of science			✓	

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks			✓	
acts on feedback to improve			✓	

Performance grade: C Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: 13/26

Joshua has shown in the recent trial examination that he is determined to come home strong. His result moves him up the standings and he should be encouraged by his progress. I would remind Joshua that half of his HSC marks are still in front of him and would like to see him pushing from this point for a sound result. He needs to place some emphasis on the relativity content from "Properties of Light" and be ready to address this content in extended response style questions. It is great to see Joshua attain some success, the motivation this brings should help him build for the final examination and a sound result.

Teacher: Mr Timothy Lilley

Science Extension

1 Unit

Students complete their coursework with data analysis and reporting of results. After finalising the practical component of their major projects, students complete their portfolios and reports, summarising the progress and findings of their 12-month project.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding			✓	
inquiring and designing				✓
processing and evaluating				✓
reflecting on the impacts of science				✓

Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: B Rank in assessment tasks: Task 3: 5/6

Joshua is to be commended for the ambitious proposition of pursuing a major research project in a field of study that he would not have been exposed to in his previous education. Although he experienced a turbulent period of locking in an inquiry question to focus his major work, he has submitted a polished final product. Most impressive is his substantial improvement in data processing and analysis. I suggest he now focus this effort towards completing practice papers online in preparation for the unique delivery of the HSC examination. It has been a pleasure to have Joshua in the Science Extension class this year.

Teacher: Mrs Erin Munn

Co-curricular summary

Sport	Football
Awards	HM List for outstanding Academic Attitude - 2020 T, HM List for Outstanding Academic Attitude- 2020 T2, HM List for Outstanding Academic Attitude- 2020 T3, HM List for outstanding Academic Attitude 2020 T4, HM List-Outstanding Academic Attitude T3,2021

